

JOHN ESCOBEDO

Austin, Texas | john.esco.work@gmail.com | (512) 299-3269

Visual Communication Specialist | Accessibility Tester | Trilingual (English/Spanish/ASL)

SUMMARY

Communication and accessibility professional with direct experience with a live video interpreting platform and disability-focused workplaces. Former team member at Communication Services for the Deaf, where the majority of colleagues were Deaf and American Sign Language was the daily working language. Trained in fine art, typography, and visual composition -- giving me a precise visual vocabulary for translating what I see into language others can use. Years of professional experience writing detailed, objective descriptions where an inaccurate account of what I observed had real consequences. Trilingual (English, Spanish, ASL) with a track record of building trust quickly and communicating clearly under pressure.

EXPERIENCE

APPTRONIK (via Insight Global) -- Robot Tele-Operator
Austin, TX | July 2025 -- September 2025

Operated humanoid robots through a VR interface, providing real-time verbal description of what the robot's cameras could see -- including field of vision, spatial orientation, and camera angles -- to support engineering and operations teams.

- Described the robot's visual field in real time through VR, calling out what the cameras could and could not see, spatial orientation, and potential obstacles -- the direct analog to audio description in a workplace setting.
- Translated observed robot behaviors into clear written reports specific enough for engineers to act on without being present.
- Authored startup, shutdown, and emergency procedures for two robot models from scratch, reducing new operator ramp-up time by approximately 50%.

GEEKSI -- Senior QA Test Lead
Tallahassee, FL (Remote) | March 2019 -- June 2025

Senior contractor supporting U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs healthcare applications. Maintained near-daily working communication with a blind VA staff member and conducted user acceptance testing directly with blind users navigating the systems they depended on -- developing a grounded, task-level understanding of what blind and low-vision professionals need from their environment to work independently.

- Performed hands-on screen reader validation using JAWS and NVDA on VA clinical interfaces -- observing how blind users navigate software to complete real tasks, and learning what information they need, in what order, to act with confidence.
- Advocated for accessibility as a core quality metric, leading Section 508 compliance testing and educating team members on inclusive design requirements.
- Handled confidential and sensitive information under strict VA and HIPAA data-privacy standards, producing documentation precise enough for distributed teams to act on findings without additional context.

COMMUNICATION SERVICES FOR THE DEAF -- QA Test Lead Austin, TX | May 2013 -- January 2015

Built the inaugural QA function for a real-time video interpreting platform serving the Deaf and hard-of-hearing community. Most colleagues were Deaf; American Sign Language was the functional language of the team and a daily workplace necessity -- learned not as coursework but because it was how we worked.

- Operated daily in a Deaf-majority workplace, learning ASL as a professional necessity and developing communication habits shaped by an environment where clarity and precision were not optional.
- Worked constantly with the interpreter relay software that professionals use to deliver live communication access sessions, gaining a platform-level understanding of what real-time interpretation services require and what is at stake when they fall short.
- Established the company's first QA process from zero, defining test procedures and benchmarks that enabled the team to ship a product that genuinely served its community.

BLIZZARD ENTERTAINMENT -- Game Master | Customer Experience & Trust Specialist Austin, TX | July 2010 -- July 2011

Provided empathetic, high-volume live support for World of Warcraft players, de-escalating emotionally charged situations through patient listening and steady, clear communication under pressure.

- De-escalated frustrated users through calm listening and measured communication, consistently turning difficult interactions into restored trust.
- Delivered real-time support via live chat and ticket systems, adapting tone and approach to each user's emotional state and specific need.

LINDEN LAB -- Community Operations | Support Tools Developer San Francisco, CA (Remote) | March 2007 -- June 2010

Frontline support and community operations for Second Life, advancing through three roles in three years based on communication quality and user advocacy.

- Managed live, in-world emergencies and user conflicts in real time, maintaining composure and communicating clearly under unpredictable conditions.
- Built rapport quickly with a large, diverse, international user community through patient, attentive live interaction.

INSTRUCTOR -- Multiple Organizations

San Francisco Bay Area & Houston, TX | 1997 -- 2002

Designed and delivered hands-on instruction in digital media, software, and visual production for adult learners at Bay Area Video Coalition (San Francisco), Media Alliance (San Francisco), Tele Atlas / Etak (Menlo Park, CA), Houston Multimedia Center (Houston, TX), and Vista College (Berkeley, CA).

- Broke down complex visual and technical concepts into clear, sequential verbal instruction for learners at varied skill levels, adapting pacing and language to each audience.
- Provided one-on-one guidance alongside group instruction, observing where understanding broke down and adjusting explanation in real time.

EDUCATION

Austin Community College -- Certificate, American Sign Language (4.0 GPA) | 2015-2017

ASL School -- Certificate, American Sign Language | 2008-2012

A.I. of Houston -- Fine Art, Typography, Layout, 3D Max | 1995-1996

Vista College, Berkeley CA -- Video Editing, Life Drawing | 2001-2002

San Jacinto College -- Computer Science, Fine Art | 1993-1995

SKILLS

Accessibility & Inclusion: JAWS Screen Reader, NVDA Screen Reader, Section 508 Compliance Testing, WCAG Awareness, Deaf Cultural Competency, Inclusive Design Advocacy

Communication: Active Listening, Real-Time Verbal Description, Spatial & Directional Description, Clear & Objective Reporting, Trilingual (English/Spanish/ASL)

Confidentiality: Confidential & Sensitive Data Handling (HIPAA, VA Healthcare)

Technical: Video Conferencing (Zoom, Microsoft Teams, and proprietary platforms), Screen Sharing, Remote Access Tools, Assistive Technology Platforms, Rapid Adoption of New and Specialized Software, Mobile Applications, Technical Troubleshooting

LANGUAGES

English (Native) | Spanish (Fluent) | ASL (Conversational)